

Steve Butterworth

Full-stack developer and product builder (Ruby on Rails)

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PROFILE

Full-stack developer who turns half-formed ideas into working software in days, then keeps it running in production for years. Have shipped more than 30 Rails applications, largely solo, for the web, for mobile and once for a 30-metre screen; between them they have served millions of users. Founded an AI-powered monitoring SaaS, and sole engineer behind the UK's leading environmental jobs platform for 13 years, Rails 1 to Rails 8. Happiest owning the whole loop: talking to non-technical stakeholders, getting a rough version in front of people for early sign-off, then supporting what ships. Years of hard live-event deadlines bred a lasting taste for simple solutions that hold up.

SKILLS

- **Programming and build:** Ruby on Rails (versions 1 to 8), HTML/CSS/JavaScript, Hotwire (Turbo/Stimulus), Tailwind, React, D3.js, PostgreSQL, SQLite, Elasticsearch, Git/GitHub. Daily use of AI coding tools (Claude Code, Codex) with strict workflows for task breakdown, test-first development (RSpec) and coding standards.
- **Prototyping and product development:** working proofs of concept in days to win stakeholder sign-off; rough versions in front of users early and often; quick to pick up new tools.
- **Systems integration:** third-party APIs, live data feeds, browser automation and LLM services woven into products; a bias for the least machinery that works.
- **Service support:** 13+ years running production services solo; monitoring, alerting, fault diagnosis and root-cause fixes.
- **User focus and communication:** direct daily contact with non-technical customers and stakeholders; plain-English explanation of technical trade-offs; comfortable bridging design, product and engineering.

EXPERIENCE

Senior Rails Developer, EnvironmentJob (contract)

2013 - Present

- Work closely with the company directors to build and maintain the UK's leading environmental jobs website.
- Sole engineer across search, advertiser and job-seeker tools, admin, CRM and reporting; changes ship in days and stay in production for years.
- Introduced Elasticsearch full-text search with faceted filtering, and an email alert system sending over 150k emails a week.
- Created AI-powered import, clean-up and classification systems, and a tool monitoring new job postings across hundreds of websites.
- Carried the platform through every upgrade from Rails 1 to Rails 8.

Founder & Developer, ChangeFlow

2023 - Present

- Founded an AI-powered website monitoring and alerting SaaS, trusted by Am Law 200 law firms; shipped the first working product in weeks, solo.
- Work directly with customers to shape the product, turning requested features around in hours.
- Engineered LLM pipelines for classification, summarisation and data cleaning, plus an in-app tool-calling AI agent.
- Now a stable, lightly-maintained side product rather than a full-time venture.

Senior Rails Developer, LEX (contract)

2019 - 2023

- Built ShotView, live 3D golf shot tracking in Three.js for NTT DATA's sponsorship of The Open Championship and Indy 500, serving over 1 million visits a day within 4 months.
- Turned creative concepts into working proofs of concept in days to win sign-off, then grew them into finished products.
- Created the NTT Data Wall and its digital twin: large-format live data displays for events and conferences.
- Shipped tablet and mobile apps for live brand activations, and touch-screen conference interactives including live polling and games.
- Led a small engineering team within a wider multidisciplinary team of creative directors, designers and producers.

Senior Rails Developer, GlaxoSmithKline Analytics Platform (contract, via Retechnica)

2019

- Delivered an early proof of concept in days to win stakeholder sign-off, then built out medical voice-of-customer analysis, interactive visualisation and PDF/PPT export; shipped on time and on budget, scoring 9/10 satisfaction from 50+ stakeholders.

Senior Rails Developer, Pulse Group (contract)

2013 - 2018

- Developed live event data walls and public event websites in Rails/JavaScript/D3.js for NTT DATA sports sponsorships (The Open Championship, BMW International Open).
- Delivered big live data screens for Team GB at the Olympic Games, and reporting tools and touch-screen interactives for Emirates Airline.

Founder & Lead Developer, Flumes

2010 - 2013

- Founded and built a social media analytics and visualisation platform from zero: live social data collected, enriched via third-party classification APIs and made explorable through interactive visualisation.
- The platform became the technical foundation for later live-event work delivered for the likes of Cambridge University Press and Team GB.

Lead Rails Developer, AlphaSights

2008 - 2010

- First employee: set the technology direction with the founders, recruited and led the initial Rails team, and built the bespoke CRM and client portal underpinning the firm's communications.

EARLIER ROLES

- **Rails & PHP Developer, Humble Technologies** (2006 - 2008): web consultancy for UK clients.
- **Senior Software Engineer, i2 Inc. (now IBM)** (2002 - 2005): led the web version of the flagship analytics tool; built a Java/JS charting SDK.
- **Software Developer, Crystal Decisions (now SAP)** (1999 - 2001): enterprise OLAP components and a front-end JavaScript SDK; mentored new developers.

ADDITIONAL

- **Co-Founder, Unicorn Studios Ipswich** (2019 - Present): co-founded a not-for-profit community co-working space for remote workers, freelancers and contractors.

EDUCATION

BSc (Hons) Computer Science, 1st Class